



— CYBER WEEKLY · 19 SEP 2026

Cisco expands Splunk's AI agents for security operations

Cisco and Splunk describe an expansion; neither announcement calls it generally available. Two Netskope venture investors distribute shares, MIND raises \$72 million, and Microsoft's release notes list network-level data loss prevention for Purview.





— SECURITY OPERATIONS

Cisco expands Splunk's AI agents

- **Cisco says new agent capabilities expand the Splunk Agentic SOC Workforce.** Splunk lists new skills for detection, investigation, response and governance.
- **Neither company's announcement calls the agent skills generally available.** An Omdia analyst's table dates them to 15 September.
- **Planned:** Agent Launchpad, for customer-built agents, is due later this year. Activity-based pricing is set for this autumn. No prices were published.
- **Our view:** Cisco is competing on its data and on controlling AI costs more than on agent autonomy.

SOURCES Cisco, 15 Sep · Splunk, 16 Sep · TechTarget, 17 Sep



— SECURE EDGE

Netskope investors distribute shares; the price rises

- **ICONIQ funds distributed 5.5 million Netskope shares** to their own investors on 16 September, for no payment. Lightspeed distributed about 3 million on 10 September.
- **These are transfers, not market sales.** The one cash sale Lightspeed reported was 10,621 shares.
- **Stephens began coverage** with an Overweight rating and a \$21 target. Shares rose nearly 19% over the week, the Motley Fool reports.
- **Our view:** distributions hand shares to holders who are free to sell. That can weigh on a recently listed share.

SOURCES SEC, 14 and 18 Sep · MarketBeat, 14 Sep · The Motley Fool, 18 Sep



— FUNDING

MIND raises \$72 million for data loss prevention

- **MIND raised a \$72 million Series B** led by Crosspoint Capital Partners. Total funding is \$112 million.
- **Company sources told Calcalist** the valuation is about \$300 million. MIND's own announcement gives no valuation.
- **Why it matters:** investors are still funding a standalone data-loss-prevention vendor, while larger platforms add the same capability.

SOURCES MIND, 17 Sep · Calcalist, 17 Sep



— DATA LOSS PREVENTION

Microsoft lists network-level data loss prevention for Purview

- **Microsoft's September release notes list general availability** for Purview data loss prevention at the network level, through Microsoft Entra Global Secure Access.
- **Microsoft says** it protects text, files and AI interactions, and detects risky user activity through Insider Risk Management.
- **Still in preview:** data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps such as Box and Google Workspace.
- **The notes give a month, not a day.** We found no Microsoft press release.

SOURCES Microsoft Learn, 16 Sep



— ACQUISITIONS

Two managed-detection deals

- **Quorum Cyber signed a definitive agreement to acquire Ontinue.** Terms were not disclosed, and no closing date was given.
- **Quorum Cyber calls the planned combination a "Microsoft-first agentic SOC".** The companies operate independently until the deal closes.
- **CyberMaxx acquired Avertium.** The deal closed on 11 September and was announced on 16 September. Terms were not disclosed.

SOURCES PR Newswire, 16 Sep · Avertium, 16 Sep



— AI SECURITY

A security benchmark for AI tool-call servers

- **The Center for Internet Security released a benchmark for Model Context Protocol servers, the connectors AI agents use to call tools and data.**
- **It has 55 recommendations across 10 areas, including logging and audit. It is free to download.**
- **We found no analyst-firm category for this market yet.**
- **Why it matters:** vendors claiming to secure AI tool calls now have a published baseline that buyers and auditors can check them against.

SOURCES Center for Internet Security, 16 Sep



— REPORTED ACQUISITION TALKS

Proofpoint and Varonis: still unconfirmed

- **Bloomberg's 2 September report of acquisition talks remains unconfirmed.** The report said talks could fall apart or another bidder could emerge.
- **Varonis has made no company filing** with the US securities regulator since 29 July.
- **Calcalist mentions a \$6–7 billion price** without naming a source. Neither company has stated a price.
- **Watch for:** a company announcement, a regulatory filing or a denial.

SOURCES Yahoo Finance, 2 Sep · SEC, read 20 Sep · Calcalist, 17 Sep



— MORE BUSINESS MOVES

Other moves to keep in view

FUNDING

Exein raised \$270 million at a \$1.7 billion valuation, led by Headline. It builds security software into connected devices.

SECURE EDGE

Netskope announced Agent Action Control. Netskope says it will be available at the end of its current quarter.

SECURE EDGE

Dell'Oro Group estimates data security and user-experience monitoring grew faster than core gateway products in a \$3.5 billion quarter.

IDENTITY

Okta appointed Helen Riley to its board; Emilie Choi stepped down. Oktane runs 22–24 September.

IDENTITY

Quest Software announced identity mapping for human, machine and AI-agent accounts. No availability date was given.

DATA SECURITY

Varonis launched Data Lifecycle Management. Varonis says it is available now.

AI SECURITY

AIUC raised \$40 million to certify enterprise AI agents. Raindrop announced a Series A led by CRV; its size was not disclosed.



— SOURCES

Sources

Company announcements, regulatory filings and reporting behind this week's stories.

COMPANY AND PRIMARY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Cisco · Splunk · SEC · MIND · Microsoft Learn · Avertium · Center for Internet Security · Netskope · Dell'Oro Group · Okta · Varonis · Raindrop

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TechTarget · MarketBeat · The Motley Fool · Calcalist · PR Newswire · Yahoo Finance · SecurityWeek · CIO Influence

Full sources accompany the weekly summary.